

Work or study

这个话题中我说的不是一个工作

Are you a student or do you have a job?

I'm a student and I go to ... University. I major in advertising.

Major in sth 主修..

Why did you choose your major?

Well, I chose advertising because I'd always been really into watching TV commercials cause I found them a lot of fun. Then I thought it would be fantastic to study them in college. So this is why I chose this major. But, to be honest, I don't think the TV commercials now are as interesting as before.

Advertising 广告学

TV commercials 电视广告

Find sth a lot of fun 觉得...很有意思

What do you plan to do after you graduate?

I plan to land a job at an advertising company. I'm quite into designing stuff and hopefully, I can do this as a living.

Land a job 找到一份工作

Do sth as a living 做...来谋生

Why did you choose this job?

Um, well, I chose to become a doctor cause I had always liked helping people. You know, as a doctor now, my job is to help and take care of patients. I get a lot of job satisfaction cause I feel like I can make a difference in people's lives.

Job satisfaction 工作满足感

Make a difference in people's lives 对别人的生活产生作用/帮助

Do you like your job?

Yeah, I do. I quite enjoy what I do on a daily basis. You know, I feel extremely delighted and proud of myself when I see someone recover from an illness.

Delighted=happy

Be proud of myself 为自己而骄傲

Recover from an illness 病好

Do you think you will change a job in the future?

Yeah, sure. I've actually been thinking of quitting lately because what I do is basically just a waste of time. I think I've idled away half a year doing this job. I'm considering studying something new, like computer programming or something, so that I can land a job at an internet company.

Quit v. 辞职

Idle away ... 浪费时间

Home

What kind of house or apartment do you live in?

I live in an apartment. It's not a very spacious one. You know, a big apartment would be super pricey. In my apartment, there's a living room, a bedroom and a balcony which is kind of my favorite place cause I often sit there in my armchair and do some reading.

Spacious 宽敞的

Pricey=expensive

Balcony 阳台

Armchair 扶手椅

Will you live there for a long time?

No, I don't think so. Although it would be fantastic if I never had to move cause that would save so much money, I still have to buy a bigger and better apartment when I get married. That would be in a couple of years I suppose.

Do you like the area where you live?

Yes, I quite like it. First of all, the public transportation is really convenient. There are so many buses I can take to the center of the city and there's a subway station within spitting distance too. Plus, there's a big supermarket and a couple of shopping malls nearby, so it's not a problem at all to pick up the groceries and do the shopping.

Within spitting distance (of ...) (离...) 很近

Pick up the groceries 买杂货

Which room in your house or apartment do you like to stay in?

Like I said just now, I like the balcony the best. Not only is it a great place for me to read, I water some flowers there every day. Yeah, it's my favorite place in the apartment.

Hometown

Where's your hometown?

I'm from Beijing, born and raised.

I'm from Beijing, born and raised. Actually I live in the northeast of Beijing. It's where the Beijing International Airport is.

Born and raised 土生土长的

Please describe your hometown a little.

Alright. I believe everybody knows about Beijing. It's been the capital of China since Yuan Dynasty, 800 years ago. Because of all the history here, there are a great number of places of interest, like the Forbidden City, the Great Wall, the Summer Palace, etc etc ...

Dynasty 朝代

Place of interest 景点

What do you like most about living there?

Well, there are many things I really like about it here, like great public transportation, fantastic food and the fact that there are a great number of places to have fun. Among all these things, I think the last one is what I love the most. You know, no matter where you live, you're always close to some karaokes or maybe bars or clubs. Anyway, you will never be bored here.

Karaoke 卡拉OK bar 酒吧 club 夜店

Is there anything you don't like about it?

Um, what I don't like about it? Well, I guess it should be the traffic. You know, every day during the rush hour, the cars on the road are really packed like sardines and so it takes you a long time to get to your destination. It really drives me crazy sometimes. It would be great if the traffic were better in my hometown.

Rush hour 高峰期

Packed like sardines 非常堵

Drive me crazy 令我很烦

Housework

Do you like doing housework?

To be honest with you, although I do it on a daily basis, I don't like it at all. Actually I don't think anyone likes doing housework. It's just that we have no choice but to do it.

How do you think housework could be made more interesting?

Um, that's super difficult. But I guess if you do it with someone you love, it could be more fun. For instance, if I have a crush on a girl, and this girl somehow asks me to help her do the laundry, I believe I will be more than happy to do it.

More fun 更有意思

Have a crush on sb 很喜欢某人

Do the laundry 洗衣服 *do/wash the dishes* 刷盘洗碗 *sweep the floor* 扫地 *mop the floor* 拖地

More than happy 很开心

Do you think children should learn to do some housework?

Yeah, definitely. When I was a kid, I always did chores around the house and my parents rewarded me with an allowance. So I think it's a great opportunity to teach children about money and its value. They'll know money isn't easily earned, so they can treasure it more. Plus, it helps to make kids healthier too. Doing housework can be seen as a physical activity and I believe I was much healthier than a lot of couch potatoes just because I did it on a daily basis.

Do chores around the house 在家里做家务

An allowance 零花钱

Treasure v. 珍惜

Physical activity 约等于 sports

Couch potato 很喜欢看电视的人

Advertising

Are there many advertisements in your country?

Oh, yes, they're everywhere. Not only can you see loads of TV commercials, you can see ads in magazines, newspapers, at subway stations and even in the restrooms in public places. I find them really annoying.

Loads of=tons of=many

Annoying adj. 烦人的

Why do you think there are so many of them?

Well, it's primarily because after a certain product is launched, the company behind it wants people to know it. The more exposure this product gets, the more likely it is that people will buy it. So yeah, this is why we have so many ads.

Launch a product 推出一个产品

Exposure n. 曝光

Likely adj. 可能的

What kind of advertisement do you like the best?

Um, this is pretty hard cause honestly, the fact that there are so many ads everywhere really drives me up the wall. But um, some TV commercials are pretty hilarious and they crack me up

from time to time. I remember once I watched a chewing gum commercial. It was so funny and I couldn't help but laugh for a long time.

Chewing gum 口香糖
Commercial 电视广告

Do you think advertisements play an important role in our life today?

Well, the first word that comes to mind is no. Although I guess many people would claim they're of great importance to us, I just don't think they're as important as before. You know, now, it's not uncommon that when people wanna buy something, they will search for the product reviews on the internet. We don't see that many people who trust advertisements anymore.

Claim v. 声称
Product reviews 产品评价

Camping

Have you ever been camping before?

Um, let me see. Yeah, I went camping once, on the Great Wall actually. It was an amazing experience. I slept in a sleeping bag with a bunch of friends on the Great Wall. That part of the wall was pretty much off the beaten path, so it was kind of adventurous really. Plus, the night views were spectacular. I couldn't help but be stunned by the millions of stars in the sky.

Off the beaten path 不经常有人去
Adventurous 冒险的、探险的
Spectacular views 很美的风景
Be stunned by 被...震惊

Is camping popular in China?

Off the top of my head, I wanna say no. At least not a lot of my friends have been camping before. Though I have done it once, I still don't think it's a popular activity in China. I hope I can go camping more with my friends.

What kinds of problems would you have while camping?

Well, the first one that comes to mind is, um, I don't think many people know how to set up a tent, so that might take some time. Another one could be bugs and um, say mosquitoes. So I don't think I can emphasize enough the importance of mosquito-repellent. Yeah, these are the things I can think of now.

Set up a tent 支起帐篷
Bugs 虫子 *mosquitoes* 蚊子
Mosquito-repellent 驱蚊剂

What are the benefits of camping?

Well, the most obvious benefit is that when you're camping, you're spending a lot of time performing physical activities, so you burn calories and it's great exercise. Besides, it's a great opportunity for people to get away from the hustle and bustle of city life. You know, we can disconnect for a few days and enjoy the simplicity of natural experience. To be honest, this is extremely precious in our life today.

Perform physical activities 做运动

Burn calories 燃烧脂肪

Hustle and bustle 熙熙攘攘

Disconnect v. 断开连接 (这里表示离开喧嚣)

Simplicity n. 简单

Precious 宝贵的

Traveling

Do you like traveling?

Yeah, I do. I'm crazy about traveling and over the years, it has already become an essential part of my life. I've been to tons of really interesting places in my country, like Tibet, Inner Mongolia, Xinjiang, Xiamen and so forth. I wish I had more time to travel cause the more I do it, the more I feel I'm living an exciting and fulfilling life.

Live a ...life 过...样的生活

Fulfilling 令人满足的

Do you think it's important to travel?

Yeah, definitely. You know, modern people are always under a lot of pressure, so I think traveling is a great opportunity to forget about work and totally wind down. And this is actually of great importance to our work cause I believe a relaxed mind is more efficient and productive.

Efficient 有效率的

Productive 高产的

In which season do you prefer to travel?

If I could, I would travel all year round. But the reality is, I only have some longer holidays in September and March, so I would say generally, I travel more in spring and fall/autumn.

All year round 一整年

Is your country a good place for travelers?

Oh, without doubt. China is a huge country and there are so many places of interest. I think the most popular tourist attractions in my country are the Great Wall, the Terra Cotta Warriors, Jiuzhaigou in Sichuan where the views would definitely take your breath away. If I kept going, we

would be talking about it all day.

Place of interest 景点 复数是 *places of interest*

Tourist attraction 景点 复数是 *tourist attractions*

Terra Cotta Warriors 兵马俑

Take your breath away (美得) 令你窒息

If I kept going, we would ... 如果我接着说... (虚拟语气)

Clothes

What clothes do you usually like to wear?

Well, most of the time, I wear jeans and a hoodie, with a T-shirt underneath. But um, you know, in order to look smart today, I'm in this shirt. But normally, I don't wear it a lot.

Jeans 牛仔裤 *hoodie* 帽衫

Underneath 在下面/里面

Look smart 看起来精神

Well, usually, I wear tight jeans cause they make me look slimmer. And um, to go with them, I just wear a simple shirt, nothing too flashy. But of course, that's in the summer. In the winter, when the wind can literally cut right through you, anyone is in a down jacket.

Tight jeans 紧身牛仔裤

Slim 苗条的

Go with sth 搭配...

Flashy 太绚丽的、有点浮夸的

The wind can cut right through you 寒风凛冽

Down jacket 羽绒服

Do you wear the same clothes on the weekend?

Yes, I do. I go to college now and there's no dress code, so I dress pretty casually on weekdays and that doesn't change on the weekend.

Dress code 穿衣标准

Dress pretty casually 穿得比较随意

No, I dress pretty casually on the weekend. But from Monday to Friday, we have a strict dress code. I have no choice but to wear a shirt/blouse.

A strict dress code 很严格的穿衣标准

Do you think you will wear the same type of clothing in the future?

Yeah, I guess so. I suppose I will look pretty much the same unless what I wear becomes

outdated. As long as most people think I dress nicely, I won't change.

Outdated 过时的了

Collecting things

Do you like to collect anything?

Well, you know, I just don't collect as much as I did before. When I was a kid, I was crazy about collecting cigarette packets. But you have to know I didn't smoke at all. Somehow, those packets with different patterns on them really appealed to me. So, yeah, collecting was an essential part of my life before, but not anymore.

Cigarette packet 烟盒

Somehow 不知为什么

Appeal to sb 吸引某人

Why do some people collect things?

Um, I guess it's because we're really into certain things and the more of them we have, the happier we are. When my collection of cigarette packets got bigger and bigger, I just felt so happy. Some other people collect things simply because of their childhood memories or um, maybe as an investment. You know, I have quite a few friends who are big antique collectors. They can definitely make a ton of money when they sell those ancient vases or pots in 30 or 40 years.

An investment 一笔投资

Antique 古董

Make a ton of money 赚很多钱

Vase 花瓶

Pot 罐子

What kinds of things do Chinese people like to collect?

Um, to be honest with you, I don't think we can generalize about it cause different people are fond of different things. But I suppose the things Chinese people collect the most are antiques, stamps, coins, and um ...I'm sure there are a lot more, but these are all I can think of now.

Generalize about sth 一概而论

Colors

What colors do you like and dislike?

My favorite color is blue. You know, a lot of my things are blue, like some of my clothes, my backpack, my table cloth, oh, I'm even thinking of redecorating my apartment and paint the walls blue. As for what color I don't like ...I guess it should be black. You know, it's just because

somehow it puts me in a bad mood.

Redecorate sth v. 重新装饰/装修
Put me in a bad mood 让我心情不好

Are there any colors that have special meanings in China?

Um, you know what, the first color that comes to mind is green. Generally it's a pretty good color. It symbolizes life and nature. But you now, in China, a green hat has a very interesting connotation. If you say that someone wears a green hat, it means that their husband or wife, boyfriend or girlfriend is cheating on them. Also, of course we all know that red stands for happiness and you see it everywhere like at weddings, festivals or any other delightful event. So this color is an essential part of our life in China. Another one I can think of is white. It's mostly seen at funerals.

Symbolize 代表
Connotation 隐含意义
Cheat on sb 出轨
Stand for 代表
Delightful 愉快的、令人开心的
Funeral 葬礼

Why do people like different colors?

Um, I think it has a lot to do with our personalities. I guess generally, those who love red are really passionate people. They're into partying and feel great when they're surrounded by loads of friends. Personally, I don't like that. My favorite color is blue and I tend to enjoy being alone and thinking. Sometimes, when I have no choice but to go and socialize, I just feel extremely uncomfortable. Plus, I suppose those who like green must be really fond of nature.

Has something to do with ... 和...有一些关系 *has a lot to do with ...* 和...有很大关系
Party v. 参加聚会
Tend to 倾向于/会...
Socialize v. 社交

Friendship

How do people in your country make friends?

Well, most people still make friends in the conventional ways, I mean at school or from work. For instance, most of my friends are either colleagues or my schoolmates before. That said, now that the internet is an essential part of our life now and we all use social media, we can also make friends on Renren and Weibo, which are the Chinese equivalents of Facebook and Twitter.

Conventional 传统的
That said 话虽如此

Social media 社交网络

Do you think it's easy to make friends at work?

Yeah, I think so. I have a lot of friends who work or worked with me. Although we always say that we're friends with someone because we have a lot in common or something like that, more often than not, it's actually because we see each other every day. So in this case, we see our colleagues on a daily basis and we hang out a lot. This is why it's easier to strike up a friendship with them.

Have a lot in common 有很多共同点

More often than not 通常

Strike up a friendship 成为朋友

How would you describe a good friendship?

Well, off the top of my head, I think you should be able to trust each other. I mean, this is of great importance. You know, I remember vividly that a couple of years ago, a friend of mine said something bad about me behind my back. I had thought that we were best friends, but that really hurt my feelings.

Behind my back 背着我

Hurt my feelings 伤了我的心

Handwriting

Do you often write things?

Yes, I do. I write every day. You know, I'm still a student, so I have tons of homework on a daily basis. But the thing is, I only write on my computer cause I think it's easier and more convenient. Oh, speaking of this, I haven't finished this week's homework, so I'll have to do it later today.

Which one do you like, sending letters or emails?

Um, I definitely prefer sending emails cause it's super fast. I just type it and click on "send", then the person I'm writing to will receive it in a fraction of the time. However, if I write a letter, it's gonna take ages before it arrives. I think it's a waste of time.

Click on sth 点击

In a fraction of the time 很快

Take ages 要很久

Do you think handwriting will one day be replaced?

Well, the first word that comes to mind is yes. You know, now, we don't see a lot of young people who like to handwrite things. They write everything with their computers or smartphones. So, in 50 or 60 years, when these people get old, I guess you will see no one using a pen any more.

Honestly, I'm one of them. I find handwriting pretty slow and so I don't like it at all.

What impressions does a person's handwriting have on people?

Well, according to some researches, our handwriting can give away clues about our personalities. Some people can tell whether we're outgoing or arrogant or even whether we have a tendency to lie. Personally, if I see some messy handwriting, I just can't help but assume whoever wrote it is unreliable. Although I might be wrong, that's what I will think.

Research 调查

Give away 泄露

Outgoing 外向的 *arrogant* 自大的

Have a tendency to lie 有说谎倾向

Messy 混乱的

Assume 认为

Unreliable 不可靠的

Letters or emails

Do you write many letters or emails?

I don't write any letters, but I write emails on a daily basis. You know, I always use email to communicate with my teacher about my reports and essays. Speaking of it, I need to check my email later after the test cause I'm waiting for a reply from my teacher about a report I wrote.

Reply n./v. 回复

What are the differences between letters and emails?

Well, off the top of my head, I'd say emails are much more convenient than letters cause after you finish writing, you just click on "send", and then the person you're writing to can receive this in a fraction of the time. Personally, I think it's a waste of time writing a letter. It takes ages before it arrives and that's why we call it snail mail now.

In a fraction of the time 很快

Snail mail=letters

Do you think people will still write letters in the future?

Honestly, I don't suppose so. First of all, it takes more time to write a handwritten letter than to write an email. Then, you have to wait a few days before whoever you're writing to gets the letter and that's why we call it snail mail. Personally, I only write emails and I've had this habit for many years. As far as I know, none of my friends still writes letters. So yeah, they will definitely be gone in the future.

Museums

Do you think museums are important?

Yeah, I do think so. I don't think I can emphasize enough the importance of museums cause they're places where we can gain a great deal of knowledge and have a lot of fun at the same time. For instance, there's a military museum within walking distance of my apartment and I go there on a quite regular basis. Over the years, I've learned a lot about military there.

Gain a great deal of knowledge 学习很多知识

Do you think it's OK for museums to sell things to visitors?

Yes, I do. Actually, it would be great if every museum had a souvenir shop or gift shop because I think many people would wanna buy something as a souvenir or a gift for someone. You know, I visited Shanxi History Museum last year and I really wanted to buy a souvenir as a reminder of my trip there, but I couldn't. I was pretty bummed out.

A reminder of sth 令人回想起...的东西

Be bummed out 很失望

Natural places

Do you like visiting natural places?

Yeah, I'm a big fan of visiting places like the sea, the desert and the grassland. Whenever I'm on holiday, if possible, I will go to one of those places and over the years, I've been to the Maldives to enjoy the spectacular ocean views, and to Inner Mongolia for the vast grassland, etc, etc. You know, I think it's a great opportunity to forget about work and totally wind down.

On holiday 在假期中

The Maldives 马尔代夫

Vast 广阔的

Wind down 放送

What are some well-known natural attractions in your country?

Oh, there are tons. The ones I can think of now include the Tenger Desert which lies in the northwest of China, Hulunbeier grassland, Yangtze River and um... Well, the list could go on and on and on. I don't think we have enough time for this. Um, speaking of these places, I wish I could visit them all in my lifetime.

The Tenger Desert 腾格里沙漠

Yangtze River 长江

How do city kids in your country connect with nature?

Honestly, I don't think they connect with nature at all. Well of course, some kids like to be in the great outdoors. They may go fruit-picking with their folks on the weekend, or go to the seaside

from time to time. But it's not uncommon that many kids are pretty sedentary and are more into watching TV and playing computer games.

The great outdoors=nature
Go fruit-picking 去采摘水果
Their folks 他们的家人
Sedentary 经常坐着的

What can people get from going to natural places?

Oh, I just happened to have read an online article about it. You know, the more we spend time in natural places, the better our creativity as well as eyesight. I'm sorry, I'm not quite sure what the scientific explanations are. Also, this is quite obvious. Um, going to natural places helps to reduce stress. You know, I can't emphasize enough the importance of this cause most modern people are always under a lot of pressure and we should definitely go out to the nature more.

Happen to do sth 碰巧/正好..
Creativity 创造力 *eyesight* 视力
Reduce stress 减少压力, 约等于 *relax*

Public holidays

What public holidays do you have in your country?

Um, let me see. We have a couple of golden weeks like the Spring Festival golden week and the National Day golden week. They're holidays of 7 days. Also, there are quite a few 3-day holidays. For instance, we have three days off around the Mid-autumn festival.

Have three days off 休息三天

Do you like public holidays?

Yeah, sure, who doesn't. I don't think there's anyone out there who claims he or she doesn't like public holidays. It's not uncommon that people will choose to go on a trip or something during these times. Normally, we're extremely tied-up with work and so we're always under a lot of pressure, and that really makes us feel quite depressed. Public holidays are when we can finally have time to wind down. I wish there were more of them.

Be tied-up with work=be busy with work
Feel depressed 感到压抑的/抑郁的

Reading

Do you like reading books?

Yeah, I'm a big bookworm. Um, although I don't often read paper books, I do a lot of reading

on my Ipad on a daily basis. Currently, I'm reading a book called *What the Dog Saw* written by my favorite writer, Malcolm Gladwell. I find it quite captivating.

Bookworm 喜欢读书的人
Captivating=*attractive*=*fascinating*

What kinds of books do you like to read?

Well, actually, I guess I could say I like all kinds of books, like novels, biographies, self-help books, etc etc. But among all these, I guess I love reading biographies the best. Not only are all the experiences of those famous people quite interesting, their success stories can always motivate me. My favorite biography is the one about Steve Jobs.

Novels 小说 *biographies* 传记 *self-help books* 励志类书籍
Motivate sb 激励某人

Did you read much when you were a child?

Um, I don't think I read a lot cause most of the time, I was outside playing soccer or other sports with my little friends. But, I do remember a time when I was really engaged in reading. I was probably 8 or 9, and on my birthday, all the gifts I received were books. I remember vividly the days after that, I was reading nonstop. You know, the more I read, the more I loved doing it.

Be engaged in sth 一直在做.../沉浸在...中
Read nonstop 毫不停歇的读书

What are the benefits of reading?

Well, off the top of my head, it helps to expand our horizons. We may not be able to travel everywhere, but we can learn about different cultures and traditions and many other aspects of our life and world without having to go out. Another obvious benefit is that it helps to broaden our vocabulary, so we get to become more articulate. You know, it's of great importance to be well-read and well-spoken in any job.

Expand one's horizons 开拓视野
Broaden one's vocabulary 扩大词汇量
Articulate=*well-spoken* 能言善辩的
Well-read=*knowledgeable*

Shoes

Do you like shopping for shoes?

No, that's not really my thing. Honestly, I have to say I'm just not so crazy about shopping cause I find it really tiring and it's a waste of time walking around in a mall for the entire afternoon. As for shoes, I only buy them when my old ones are worn-out.

Not my thing 我不喜欢

Worn-out 穿坏了的

How often do you go shopping for shoes?

Like I said, I don't often go shopping for shoes, so it's something like three times a year I guess.

What kind of shoes do you like to wear?

Well, um, most of the time, I wear sneakers cause they're really comfortable and I can do anything in them. But recently, I really feel like a change. You know, last Saturday, I went to the mall with my girlfriend cause I wanted her to help me find some good canvas shoes. I did buy a pair, but I'm not wearing them today.

Sneakers 运动鞋

Feel like a change 想做个改变

Canvas shoes 帆布鞋

Do you prefer comfortable shoes or good-looking one?

It's of great importance that my shoes are comfy cause I do a lot of physical activities every day and I don't want my feet to get hurt. But of course, it would be fantastic to wear shoes that are both comfy and beautiful.

Shopping

Do you like shopping?

Well, I guess I should say I don't like shopping in physical stores. Most of the time, I just buy things online, like on Taobao or Jingdong. You know, they're two popular online shopping sites in China.

Physical stores 实体店

Online shopping sites 网上购物网站

What do you usually buy when you go shopping?

Um, it's a little embarrassing to say, but I always buy a lot of snacks on Taobao. When I go to the supermarket, I just buy the daily necessities, such as tissues, shampoo and stuff.

Snacks 零食

Daily necessities 日常必需品

Tissues 纸巾 *shampoo* 洗发液

And stuff=and so on

Would you like to work in a shopping center?

No, I would never consider that. I guess I would find it pretty dull and boring working in a shopping center because I would be standing behind a counter or in the same place all day long.

Besides, I think great communication skills are of great importance for those who work there. However, I don't suppose I have them. So I'm not really the type of person that could work well in a mall.

Communication skills 沟通能力

What do you think of online shopping?

I think it's awesome. For starters, it's extremely convenient. I mean, with a click of the mouse, you can buy things and have them delivered to you the next day. Plus, the things you buy are usually cheaper than in physical stores like shopping malls, supermarkets, and department stores. For example, if you buy a book that costs 50, you will usually get a 15 or 20% discount on Amazon or Dangdang. Oh, Dangdang is the Chinese equivalent of Amazon.

Awesome=very good

For starters 首先

With a click of the mouse 点一下鼠标

Have sth delivered to you 让别人给你邮寄过来

Department store 百货商场

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Sky

Do you like to watch the sky?

Do I like to watch the sky? Um, it's a really interesting question. I suppose I do, but this is because I have a stiff neck and looking up can help me feel more comfortable. Of course, sometimes, if it's not smoggy, I will look up at some stars at night. But usually, there are just a few of them.

Have a stiff neck 颈椎不好

Smoggy 有雾霾的

What is the sky like at night in your hometown?

Well, there are only a few stars in the sky most of the time. You know, I'm from Beijing, and due to air pollution, it's not uncommon that we don't see any stars at night. But luckily, it's getting better these days. I remember that I even saw the Big Dipper a couple of weeks ago. You know, I was walking back home and then I looked up, and to my surprise, I just saw it. It was amazing to me cause you don't see it that often in Beijing.

The Big Dipper 北斗七星

To my surprise 令我惊喜的是

Have you ever taken a course about stars?

No, I haven't and to be honest, I don't think any of my friends has. I don't really see the need

to take it.

What's your favorite star?

My favorite star? Oh, God, I don't know any stars actually. Oh, wait, I only know the Big Dipper, but that should be a constellation.

Constellation 星座 (一个人的星座是 *star sign* 或者说 *sign*)

Sleeping

How many hours do you sleep every day?

Um, let me count. Usually I hit the sack at 11 or 11:30, and I get up around 7:30, so yeah, it's about 8 hours every day. But you know, sometimes, if I have a report due the next day, I will have no choice but to pull an all-nighter or something. So in that case, I will only sleep 3 or 4 hours.

Hit the sack=go to bed

Have a report due 有报告要交

Pull an all-nighter 熬夜

Is it necessary to take a nap every day?

Yeah, I do think so. I believe that the better we rest at noon, the more energetic we will be in the afternoon. So it's really important to have forty winks after lunch. You know, I say it also because I do it on a daily basis. I always feel very drowsy around 3 o'clock if I don't take a nap.

Have forty winks 小睡一会

Feel drowsy 感到困倦, 约等于 *sleepy*

How do you think we can have a good sleep?

Well, I suppose there are quite a few things we can do in order to have a sound sleep such as drinking some warm milk, doing a bit of reading before going to bed, listening to soft music, etc etc. I think among these, reading is probably the most effective cause you gradually get tired and it really helps you to fall asleep faster.

Have a sound sleep 睡个好觉

Effective 有效的

Fall asleep 入睡

Teachers

Do you or did you have a favorite teacher?

Yes, I did. I really liked my history teacher in middle school and I believe it was him who sparked my love for this subject. You know, he was a very hilarious guy and would always tell

many jokes in class, so he could always crack us up. This is why everyone in the class was really fond of him. I remember clearly that at one point, he was going to be replaced by another history teacher cause he would go and teach high school. We even protested in order to keep him. But sadly, we didn't succeed.

Spark my love for sth 激起我对...的爱

Hilarious=funny

Crack sb up 另谋人笑

Protest v. 抗议

Do you think you could be a teacher?

No, I don't think so. You know, teachers need to be really patient, but honestly, I'm not like that. If I were a teacher, and if a student made a mistake over and over again, I guess I would just lose my temper. I don't think such a person could be a good teacher.

Over and over gain 一次又一次的

Lose my temper 发脾气

What are the qualities of a good teacher?

Well, I believe not only does a good teacher have to knowledgeable, but he or she also needs to be inspirational. You know, back in high school, my math teacher would always tell us his backstory. His was born in a really poor family in a poverty-stricken area. He studied extremely hard every day in order to get into a top-notch university so he could land a good job in the city. I think his stories really motivated us and we worked really hard too.

Knowledgeable=well-read

Inspirational 激励人的/鼓舞人心的

Backstory 曾经的故事/经历

Poverty-stricken 很贫穷的

Top-notch 非常棒的

Land a job 找到一份工作

Television

Do you like watching TV?

Yes I do enjoy watching TV, but sometimes I think it's a waste of time cause I can stare at the TV screen all day long. I should try to cut down on the time I spend on it.

Stare at sth 盯着看

Cut down on sth 减少...

Did you watch TV a lot when you were a child?

Yes, I did. It was an essential part of my life. Sometimes, I would be lying on the couch all

day watching cartoons. I remember my favorite one was called something like *Big Head son and Small Head father*. I know it's an odd name, but I was a huge fan of it.

Odd=strange

Do you think television has changed a lot in the past few years?

I'm not quite sure what you mean by change, but there are a lot more commercials on TV now and I find them really annoying. When I watch a TV show, there are a few ads every 15 minutes, so I don't think watching TV is as enjoyable as before.

Commercial n. 广告

Annoying 令人烦的

Ad=advertisement

Enjoyable 令人享受的

Trees

Do you like trees?

Um, do I like trees? That's a weird question. You know, I like watching movies, I like playing soccer, but trees ... They're extremely important, but I don't have any special feelings for them.

Are there any special trees in your country?

Well, off the top of my head, I think pine trees are pretty special. What I only know about them is that they stand for longevity. Besides, perhaps willows are special too. You know, willow in Chinese is 柳, it sounds like 留, which means to stay. So we have tons of poems in China that are about willows. But they were written because people didn't want their friends or relatives to leave. Honestly, I wish I knew more about the special trees in China, but I really don't.

Pine trees 松树

Stand for longevity 代表长寿

Willows 柳树

Poem 诗

What are the benefits of having trees?

Oh, there are loads of benefits. We can't really emphasize enough the importance of trees in our life. For starters, they make oxygen and help to purify the air. This is especially important for large cities like Beijing and Shanghai where there's a lot of air pollution. Trees can also help to muffle urban noises. If, for example, there are many trees around your apartment, it's likely to be less noisy. There are many more benefits of having trees and I guess we could talk about it all day.

Make oxygen 制造氧气

Purify the air 净化空气

Muffle urban noises 减少城市噪音

Visitors

Do you like visitors coming to your home?

Yeah, I guess so. Although I don't always have a lot of visitors coming, I do enjoy it when I throw a party with a bunch of friends at home once in a while. Um, we always have a blast drinking and watching movies or playing some silly games. Well, speaking of visitors, I'm actually gonna have a couple of friends coming over tomorrow.

Throw a party 开聚会
Have a blast 玩得很开心

When someone visits you, how do you usually show hospitality?

Well, off the top of my head, I guess it's extremely important that I clean my apartment beforehand cause if it's super dirty and messy, no one will enjoy the stay at all. And um, also, every time someone's coming, I try to make sure that I have different kinds of drinks at home. You know, it's always good if I have what my guest likes.

Hospitality n. 热情好客
Beforehand 提前

What kind of manners do you expect your visitors to have?

Well, to be honest, I've never given it a lot of thought cause I just want my guests to make themselves at home and feel comfortable. But if I had to give an answer, I'd say it would be great if everyone could stay till the end of the party. You know, there's always someone who leaves halfway and it doesn't make me feel very good.

Manners 礼貌
Make oneself at home 别拘束、把这里当成自己家
If I had to give an answer, I'd say ... 如果我必须回答的话, 我觉得...
Halfway 在中途

Do you bring gifts when you visit others?

I only bring a gift when I visit someone for the first time and what I bring depends on what that person is into. For instance, last month, I visited a girl I had met at work. She invited us over for a DVD night and I just brought her a couple of DVDs that I liked.

Meet at work